

The harbour had emptied by the time she reached the wall.  
Salt had dried white along the seams of her only good coat.

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Nobody came down to the water at that hour except the gulls.

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She counted the boats twice and got a different answer each time.

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he was wearing a pair of

old canvas trousers he never washed

The ferryman had a way of looking past whoever was speaking.

Rain arrived from the west without troubling to announce itself.  
Her brother had written once, in pencil, and never again after.

Her brother had written once, in pencil, and never again after.  
The road out of town climbed until the roofs fell out of sight.

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Someone had left a chair on the quay, facing the wrong way.



Someone had left a chair on the quay, facing the wrong way.  
By evening the tide had taken back everything it had lent.

By evening the tide had taken back everything it had lent.  
She learned the timetable by heart and then ignored it.

She learned the timetable by heart and then ignored it.  
The last light went out of the water like a held breath.

The last light went out of the water like a held breath.

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